

CYBERSECURITY PORTFOLIO

RESEARCH & ANALYSIS · THREAT INTELLIGENCE

Lazarus Windows Zero-Day Attack Analysis

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Portfolio Edition

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Lazarus Windows Zero-Day Attack (8/12/2026)

- North Korean hacking group **Lazarus**
- Known for sophisticated, state-sponsored cyberattacks
- Defense and aerospace companies
- Organizations involved in sensitive military and national-security work
- **What happened?**
 - Lazarus exploited a **Windows zero-day vulnerability**
 - **CVE-2026-68820**
 - Vulnerability allowed attackers to **escalate privileges**
 - Gave attackers greater control over compromised systems
 - Part of **Operation Dream Job**
 - Gained access from social engineering to target employees
 - Fraudulent recruitment offers
 - Exploited the Windows vulnerability after gaining access
 - Deployed **FudModule**, a kernel-level rootkit
 - Helps hide malicious activity
 - Provides deeper control of the system
 - Zero-day = vulnerability unknown or unpatched when exploited
 - Privilege escalation can turn limited access into **administrator-level control**
 - Rootkits can make detection more difficult

Source:

<https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/lazarus-hackers-exploited-windows-zero-day-to-target-defense-firms/>

- **Main takeaway**
 - Lazarus shows how attackers can combine **social engineering + zero-days + malware**

